

The current preview of Azure Stack relies on Windows Server 2012 R2. However, the final release version is going to be based on Windows Server 2016, and has parts that Microsoft has reserved towards its latest vision for an enterprise cloud stack including Windows Server Containers (Docker) and Hyper-V Containers.

According to Mike Neil, vice president of Microsoft's enterprise cloud group, the other key benefit of this is that it permits Microsoft to offer customers something that is similar to the full cloud experience in places where the Azure data centre is not present.

The digiKam 5.0 beta3 image editor has a new lookup tools



digiKam, an open source, cross-platform and free image editor software, is generally shipped as default with many KDE desktop environment set-ups on most Linux kernel-based operating systems. Its developers are right now busy adding a number of features along with fixing bugs and annoyances in the subsequent major version of

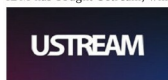
the software, digiKam 5.0. This is going to be released in the first week of May.

As cited in a recent announcement by its team, "The digiKam team is proud to announce the release of digiKam Software Collection 5.0.0 beta3. This version is a new stage in the long way to stabilise code of Qt5 port of the next main digiKam release. As usual, with this new release, we have introduced a lot of bug fixes compared to previous ones..."

Apart from bug fixes, the digiKam 5.0 Beta3 will come with a new tool known as 3D LUT (3D lookup table) that allows its users to apply some very nice colour effects to their photos, including those that are vintage, high contrast, or over saturated. The tool is present in the Image Editor and Batch Queue Manager.

IBM buys Ustream to boost its cloud services

IBM has bought Ustream, which is an online video streaming service



provider, to boost its cloud offerings for businesses. Ustream has NASA, Samsung Electronics, Facebook, Nike and the Discovery Channel among its clients, offering live as well as on-demand video to over 80 million viewers per month. The financial details of the deal were not disclosed by IBM, but as per *Fortune* magazine's report, the transaction is estimated to be valued at US\$ 130 million.

IBM has been moving away from hardware, with the sale of its low-margin businesses including low-end servers and semiconductors. This is with the aim of focusing on high-margin products like cloud-based services, mobile security and Big Data. However, the new businesses have not been able to compensate for the revenue that has been lost through divestitures.

Ustream has its headquarters in San Francisco and is part of IBM's cloud video services unit, which is being headed by its GM, Braxton Jarratt.

IBM launches Quarks, an open source development tool

IBM has made an announcement regarding the release of a new development tool known as Quarks.

The tool is based on IBM Streams, which is a proprietary tool for processing wide quantities of live data. Quarks is an open source tool permitting programmers and manufacturers to create applications over connected devices. It also allows them to benefit from the live data created through connected devices.

IBM is striving to create a community of developers and firms for this product, hoping that this open source development tool will become the standard way in which certain types of IoT apps are made. The tool can be applied for safety in mining or other dangerous outdoor industries, or in health. In the health scenario, IBM can also link this new tool to Watson Health to review data and provide doctors and patients with feedback.

IBM is also the largest backer of Blockchain, the open ledger technology. As per IBM's senior vice president, Arvind Krishna, "I think the number of places that a distributed ledger can be used could become almost limitless."

The company will be making contributions to the Hyperledger project, and will be introducing new services for assisting software developers in creating Blockchain services on its mainframe computers and devices via RFID tags. Apart from IBM, firms like Accenture, Fujitsu, Cisco, Red Hat and Hitachi are also involved in the Hyperledger project. IBM is also planning to establish a network of 'IBM Garages' in London, New York, Singapore and Tokyo to permit its customers to experiment with Blockchain.